

How to Use Your Schedule E Tax-Prep Workbook

SKU TAX-004 • SCHEDULE E TAX-PREP WORKBOOK

A wizard that captures every input the IRS Schedule E (Form 1040) needs for residential rental real estate — line by line, per property, up to 3 properties. Output is a print-ready Schedule E your CPA copies into the actual form.

Wizard flow (8 tabs)

This file ships in two versions:

- **DEMO** — already populated with three sample properties (Smokies Ridge, Creek Side, Lakehouse A). Open it first to see what filled-out looks like.
- **BLANK** — your real workbook. Same 8 tabs, no data.

Open **BLANK** and walk the tabs left to right.

Step 1 — Property Info (tab 1)

For each property (up to 3): address, type code (1=single-family, 3=vacation/STR, etc. — dropdown), fair-rental days, personal-use days, % ownership, date placed in service, EIN, QJV election.

Personal-use > 14 days OR > 10% of rental days fires a vacation-home rules callout.

Step 2 — Income (tab 2)

Per property: rents received, royalties (usually 0), refundable deposits.

Refundable deposits are NOT income until forfeited — the workbook calls this out.

Step 3 — Expenses (tab 3)

14 Schedule E expense lines × 3 properties. Categories match the IRS form line numbers exactly so your CPA copies without re-mapping.

Step 4 — Depreciation (tab 4)

Per property: depreciable basis, date placed in service, recovery period (27.5-yr residential / 39-yr non-residential), accumulated prior depreciation. Workbook outputs the annual figure but does NOT recalculate Form 4562 — for a fuller depreciation breakdown, see TAX-009 Section 179 Planner and TAX-010 Cost Segregation DIY.

Step 5 — Loss Limitations (tab 5)

Active participation? Material participation? STR loophole eligibility? AGI for \$25K phase-out? Prior suspended losses?

Workbook flags whether you qualify for the \$25K offset, the STR loophole, or are passive-locked.

Step 6 — Schedule E Map (tab 6)

Auto-built. Mirrors Schedule E Part I lines 1–26. **This is the tab you print** for your CPA.

Step 7 — Launch (tab 7)

Readiness dashboard + print packet. If you set up substantial-services on Settings, this also fires a Schedule C trigger warning (you may need TAX-008 Self-Employment Tax instead).

At tax time

1. Open **Launch** tab → click "Print Schedule E packet."
2. Send to CPA. CPA bills 90 minutes instead of 9 hours.

Questions?

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Upgrade path: Tax Season Bundle (\$147) at thestrledger.com/tax-bundle — Schedule E + Schedule C + Mileage + 1099 + Home Office + Section 179 + Quarterly Estimateds + Per-Diem.

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